Bauxite is mined around the gulf of Carpentaria, perth and Tasmania. Petroleum and natural gas is obtained from Bass Strait and west of Brisbane. Uranium is mined in northern territory at Ram jungle and Queensland. Gold is mined in the western desert at Kalgoorlie and Koolgarlie. Lead, Zinc, Silver, Manganese, Tungsten, Nickel and copper are also mined in parts of Australia.

Industries

Food and beverage manufacturing industry is the primary industry in Australia. ship building, information and technology, mining, aviation and telecommunication industries are the other important industries.

ACTIVITY

There are eight deserts in Australia. List them out with the help of Atlas.



The temperate grass land of Australia is known as '**Downs**'.

Transport

Many form of transports are available in Australia. This country is highly dependent on road transport. There are more than 30 airports with paved runways. Passenger rail transport includes widespread commuter networks in the major cities with limited intercity and interstate networks.

Population

As of 2019 the population of Australia is about 25.2 million. It constitutes only 0.33% of the total world's population. The population density of Australia is 3 persons per sq km. Urban population of the country is about 85.7 percent. Southeastern part of Australia is the densely populated region.

Antarctica

Location and Size

Antarctica is a unique continent but it does not have a native population. There is no country in Antarctica. Antarctica is the southernmost and fifth-largest continent in the world. Since it is located in the polar region, it is the coldest continent with a permanent cover of ice. It is separated from the rest of the world by the icy water of the southern portions of the Indian, Atlantic and Pacific Oceans. It covers about 9.3% of the earth surface with an area of over 14 million sq km. This continents landform consists of some mountain ranges, peaks, valleys, glaciers plateau, ice shelf, lakes and volcanoes. The length of the Trans-Antarctic mountain is 3200 km which divides the entire continent into two halves:

1. West Antarctica
2. East Antarctica

The West Antarctica faces the Pacific Ocean. The Antarctic Peninsula which points towards the South America shows that it is the continuation of the Andes mountain range. The East Antarctica faces the Atlantic and the Indian Oceans. The Mt. Erebus in this region is an active volcano. It is located in the Ross Island.

It is the only continent called white continent. In some places its ice cap is 4,000 meters deep.



Scientists of any country are free to conduct experiments and collect data from Antarctica. Hence it is called '**continent of Science**'.

Climate

The climate of Antarctica is freezing cold, because of its distance from the Equator. During the months of May, June and July (winter period of Antarctica) the sun never rises in this region. So, the temperature at the South Pole falls to -90°C. In the summer months of December, January

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